

KYLE GAARDER

Events & Community Leader | Programming | Shared Spaces

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SUMMARY

Community programmer and event designer with a portfolio of 48+ recurring events, 4 mastermind programs, and 6 work-trade initiatives built from scratch. I design programming that makes people choose one space over another. My background in coliving and coworking gives me deep understanding of how events drive member acquisition, retention, and community identity.

EXPERIENCE

Founder, Product & Operations

Revillage Coliving

- 📅 08/2022 - 07/2024 📍 Austin, TX
- Launched an 8-bedroom coliving property in 2 weeks, reaching
 - 100% occupancy before lease start
 - Designed and ran 48 weekly community dinners, 4 mastermind cohorts, and 6 work-trade programs
 - Built programming portfolio that drove 94% occupancy retention for 19 consecutive months
 - Created onboarding and community loop systems that converted new members into engaged residents
 - Executed A/B testing on pricing and stay-length models, generating 48% annual revenue lift
 - Directed full-cycle operations, improving efficiency 212% YoY across events and facility ops
 - Facilitated smooth acquisition transition to Macro House while maintaining community continuity

Co-Founder, Strategy & Operations

Van Village

- 📅 01/2021 - 08/2022 📍 Portland, OR
- Built demand pipeline of 3,140 subscribers through grassroots
 - community outreach
 - Conducted 48 customer interviews to understand community needs and event preferences
 - Explored partnerships across 5 states and personally secured an investor-backed pilot program
 - Led community concept development across strategy, ops, and programming in startup environment

Co-Founder, Operations & Growth

Lake Barcroft Boats

- 📅 01/2011 - 01/2016 📍 Falls Church, VA
- Built a niche service business from zero to 140+ clients
 - Achieved 82% customer retention through relationship-driven service
 - Generated 46% year-over-year revenue growth by improving pricing, operations, and service offerings
 - Personally closed 30-40 new clients per summer through direct outreach and referrals
 - Managed scheduling, pricing, contractors, and customer relationships across 230+ completed service contracts

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- 💎

48+ Events Built from Scratch
Designed and executed 48 dinners, 4 masterminds, and 6 work-trade programs from zero
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94% Retention via Programming
Event-driven community design sustained 94% occupancy for 19 months
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48% Revenue Growth
A/B tested pricing and engagement models driving 48% annual revenue increase
- 💎

Investor Pilot Secured
Sourced and secured an investor-backed pilot for a new community concept across 5 states
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Demand Pipeline Built
Built early demand pipeline of 3,140 subscribers through concept validation and outreach

SKILLS

- Event Design & Production
- Community Programming
- Member Engagement
- Shared Space Operations
- Facilitation Masterminds
- Stakeholder Management Vendors
- Partnerships Market Creation

EDUCATION

- Bachelors in Science, Biology**
Virginia Tech

📅 08/2010 - 05/2014
📍 Virginia, USA
 - Minors in Psychology, International Studies, Spanish

GPA
3.5 / 4.0